



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

adhyayana.pāragāḥ siddhā ye ca kaulāsa tāpasāḥ | KAZ14.3.24ab
etebhyaḥ sarva.siddhebhyaḥ kṛtaṁ te svāpanaṁ mahat || 24 || KAZ14.3.24cd
"suvarṇa.puṣpīṁ brahmāṇīṁ brahmāṇaṁ ca kuśa.dhvajam | KAZ14.3.34ab
sarvāś ca devatā vande vande sarvāṁś ca tāpasān || 34 || KAZ14.3.34cd

— Arthaśāstra, Chapter 3 (Section 178): Deceiving through Occult Practices (cont.) (Chapter 3), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Arthaśāstra, while often viewed through the lens of political strategy and economic management, also contains subtle spiritual undertones. This passage, seemingly dealing with deceptive practices involving occultism, offers a deeper understanding when viewed metaphorically. The verses speak of deceiving through the invocation of learned scholars, accomplished individuals, and ascetic practitioners. However, instead of literal deception, consider this an allegory for the illusion of external authority.

The text mentions those "perfected" in knowledge and those who are ascetics. These figures, representing external sources of wisdom and spiritual guidance, can inadvertently lead you astray if you blindly accept their teachings without engaging your own discernment. The "great sleep" induced upon them symbolizes the state of being lulled into complacency, accepting dogma without critical thought. The invocation of deities like Brahma and honoring ascetics could represent the potential for rituals and external practices to become substitutes for genuine inner transformation.

In modern life, we are constantly bombarded with information and guidance from various sources: experts, gurus, influencers. This passage reminds you to approach these sources with a critical and discerning mind. Don't blindly accept everything you hear or read, no matter how authoritative the source seems. Cultivate your own inner wisdom and intuition. Just as the text suggests caution against being lulled into a "great sleep" by external authorities, you must remain awake and aware, actively questioning and integrating information into your own understanding of the world. True spiritual growth comes from your own internal journey, not from passively following others. The real value lies in your own self-realization, recognizing the divine within yourself, rather than merely worshipping external forms.

This verse emphasizes the importance of self-reliance and independent thinking on your spiritual path. You must become your own authority, guided by your inner compass.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you blindly following any external authorities in your life, and how can you cultivate more self-reliance on your spiritual journey?